



Stanford University – Academic Shop Safety Program Attachment 4 - Solo Work Risk Reduction Plan - Form

Instructions: Academic Shops on Stanford University property must comply with the following:

GENERAL SOLO WORK RULES IN ACADEMIC / STUDENT SHOPS

1. Shop access outside of supervised hours is restricted to specific “Authorized Persons” based upon the Shop Manager’s discretion. Access for on-going solo work is not granted in any Academic Shop. On-going and/or routine solo work outside of ‘normally scheduled operation and/or staffed hours’ is strictly forbidden and may result in revocation of shop-use privileges by the Shop’s owner department.
2. An “Authorized Person” may work solo in a Shop during ‘normally scheduled operation and/or staffed hours’ when communications means are made with the Shop Manager / Supervisor to assure the person’s continuous safety and ability to communicate immediately with emergency responders.
3. When using large fixed powered shop equipment, flammable solvents, acids and/or etchants, heat and/or spark-producing equipment, at least one other Authorized Person must be in the shop area.

RISK MITIGATION PLAN FOR SPECIFIC SOLO WORK

When solo work must be conducted outside of “normally schedule operations and/or staffed hours”, this Risk Mitigation Plan (Pages 3&4) must be completed and documented by the Solo Worker, in consultation with and approval by the Shop Manager, that address the following:

1. Requests to work alone after hours, or on weekends, must be approved by the Shop Manager case-by-case each time solo work is to be performed.
2. Consult with the Shop Manager when planning to work alone. What operations will be conducted, and what means for immediate communication in an emergency are needed during solo work?
3. Development of the Solo Work Risk Mitigation Plan must include review of the specific work activities, associated hazards and hazard controls to be used; and an emergency communication plan including contact name(s) and contact method(s).
4. If possible, solo workers should communicate with others in the building when working alone in the shop. Let them know when you arrive, what you’re doing and when you leave.
5. Always avoid performing any high-hazard operations when working alone in the shop.
6. Never leave shop equipment unattended and operating.

Shop Managers must consider requests to work solo on a case-by-case basis. Any combination of the following must be considered to ensure control of the hazards of solo work to an effective degree:

- The authorized shop user’s training and experience.
- Tasks and hazards involved in the planned solo work.
- The likelihood of an injury or illness that would prevent the shop user from calling for help.
- Consequences resulting from a worst-case scenario of sudden injury or illness.
- Deadlines, time-constraints and harried pressure to complete work that could negatively affect the shop user’s safe work-methods and clear-headed work-approach.
- The shop user’s physical condition and any constraints that may impact their safe work approach and methods. [Consult with local Human Resources Officer for guidance and compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA)].
- The time of day solo work is to be conducted, for example, during normal business hours (7 am – 6 pm Monday through Friday) versus at night or weekends/holidays.
- The length of time the solo work is to be done (e.g. 5 minutes vs 5 hours vs 5 days)
- What Personal Protective Equipment should be worn during solo work?
- What Emergency Response Procedures, equipment and/or contact information is needed for solo work to take place? Besides the solo worker, who needs access to this information and equipment? How will they get this information prior to work commencing?
- Safe and unobstructed access to the nearest eyewash, shower, and fire extinguisher.



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Solo Worker: _____ Cell Phone: _____

Planned Work Activities: _____

Date / Time / Duration of Solo Work: _____ / _____ / _____

Location of Solo Work: _____

Solo Buddy Contact Name: _____ Cell Phone: _____

Emergency Contact Name: _____ Cell Phone: _____

Shop Manager Name: _____ Cell Phone: _____

RISK MITIGATION PLAN

The shop manager in conjunction with the solo worker may choose to implement any combination of the following risk-reduction options to control the hazards of solo work. These strategy options are to be implemented by honor system and mutually agreed to between Shop Manager and the Authorized Person on a case-by-case basis prior to the shop user being allowed to work solo in an academic shop:

HAZARD REDUCTIONS (Check all that apply)

- ☐ Always wear proper PPE including (list) _____
- ☐ Only hand-tool use is allowed when working solo.
- ☐ Limit higher-hazard solo work to normal week-day business hours when other personnel are likely to be nearby and able to respond to an emergency.
- ☐ Substitute low-hazard chemicals for high hazard chemicals while doing solo work. (e.g., use water-based paint instead of oil-based paint and solvents)
- ☐ Avoid setting up large-scale/hazardous projects when working solo.
- ☐ Adopt Shop Rules so that No High-Hazard Work is done solo nights and weekends, including:
 - ☐ Hazardous Chemical Use (Solvents, Etchants, Acids, Fuels, etc...)
 - ☐ Powered Machinery use
 - ☐ Hand-held Power Tools use
 - ☐ Heat / Spark / Arc / Open Flame / Smoke producing operations

ADMINISTRATIVE CONTROLS AND/OR "BUDDY SYSTEM" (Check all that apply)

- ☐ Set up a Buddy system – In person OR by cell phone / radio. Either way, your buddy must be able to recognize trouble and seek emergency help without the shop user's assistance.
- ☐ Develop and share specific emergency procedures with your buddy using this "Solo Work Risk Reduction Plan".
- ☐ Install an "emergency response" / "person down" app on your mobile device that will automate the call-out function in the event the solo worker stops moving or becomes horizontal for an extended period of time.
- ☐ Communicate with others in the building, building security, campus police or the shop manager. Let them know when you arrive, what you're doing and how long you intend to be there, and when you leave.
- ☐ Have your buddy check in on you every 10-15 minutes, OR....Check-in with your buddy every 10-15 minutes.
- ☐ Keep shop doors open (when there's no door window) or unlocked (with a door window) when solo work is happening.
- ☐ Setup your buddy in a safe place in the shop or shop-adjacent so they can be present and aware of your wellbeing if you must do high-hazard solo shop work.

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DESCRIBE ANY OTHER PROCESSES, PLANS OR COMMUNICATION STRATEGIES TO ENSURE SAFE SOLO WORK FOR THIS LIMITED TIME:

SOLO WORKER SIGNATURE / DATE: _____ / _____

SHOP MANAGER SIGNATURE / DATE: _____ / _____

Instructions: Shop Manager, please keep completed copies of these forms (pages 3 & 4 only) on file for each time solo work is approved in your shop. Completed forms should be kept on file for 3 years after end of employment, or use of shop by Shop User.